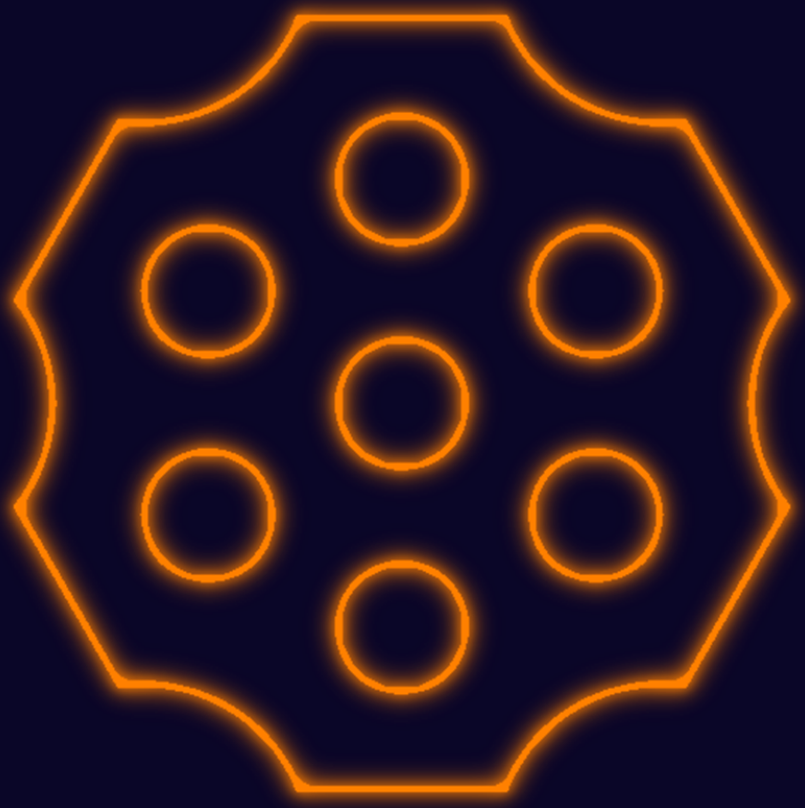
CHVMBER



Design Document

Oatcake Interactive

Current GDD Status: Incomplete

GDD KEY

Content marked in **WHITE** is implemented in the engine!

Content marked in **GREEN** is wanted but not implemented!

Content marked in **YELLOW** is still up for debate/design discussion!

Content marked in **RED** has been discussed and decided to be dropped (kept in the doc just in case)!

Contents Pages

Contents

Design Document 1

Oatcake Interactive 1

Current GDD Status: Incomplete 1

GDD KEY 2

Contents Pages 2

Game Overview 4

Initial Concept 4

Genre 4

Target Audience 5

Core Gameplay Pillars 5

Game Loop 7

General Game Flow 9

Player Picks 1 of 3 Stages 10

Player Enters Stage 12

Player Attempts to Clear Bounty .... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**

Player Receives Reward 14
Player Continues to the Next Stage (Difficulty Increases) 15
Gameplay Mechanics..... 16
Bullets..... 7
Bullet Pickups 18
Vendors 20
Enemies / Gangs ..... **Error! Bookmark not defined.**

Game Overview

"A FPS-Roguelike where instead of upgrading the player, you upgrade each bullet!"

Initial Concept

Most roguelikes assign upgrades more generically to the player (i.e. increasing general damage, movement speed, etc.). CHVMBER will instead assign these upgrades to individual bullets in a revolving gun chamber. Healing, damage, movement and even unique abilities can only be triggered by shooting the revolver! The player must craft their run; intricately assign upgrades to each bullet to build a run capable of reaching the end.

Set in a Space-Cowboy theme, the player's goal is to get as far as possible and clear the final goal/stage!

Genre

FIRST PERSON – Focus on a mid-paced shooter game that picks up the pace as more upgrades are added, and the difficulty ramps up.

ROGUE LIKE/LITE – The game is played in runs like most roguelikes, where the player aims to get as far as possible. They either beat the run or must start from the beginning. However, there are elements of progression through unlocking different upgrades that will appear in future runs. They may also potentially unlock different weapons!

Target Audience

Movement Shooter Fans – People who enjoy games that focus less on realism and more on smooth-flowing FPS combat akin to movement shooters like Overwatch and Deadlock. There should not be many controls to make combat very easy to learn, with most skill coming from upgrade/build choices.

Roguelike Fans – Players who enjoy the feeling of progression and strength build-up should find this game appealing.

Intuitive Gameplay – With very few buttons and a clearly laid out gameplay structure, it should not take longer than 15 minutes at all to get a grasp of the gameplay loop and the flow of combat.

Core Gameplay Pillars

Chamber Progression / Modularity – As it is the crux of the game, the chamber system should be vast and offer many different upgrade types, allowing for fun decision-making. Bullets should be able to play off each other well, and upgrades should not diminish each other or other bullets.

Smooth Flowing Combat – The general FPS gameplay with or without upgrades should feel refined and enjoyable at a basis. If this is done wrong, the whole game will feel Janky and unenjoyable in the early stages of a run!

Balanced Player Agency to Randomness – Like many roguelikes, there should be a fine balance between the amount of control the player has over their runs. Giving too little control will make the player feel powerless and reduce tactical decision-making, whereas too much control will discourage a player from trying out new runs! Finding a balance should be key!

Build Possibilities and Breaking Expectations – Some upgrades should also drive players to lean into certain unique aspects of the game, thus encouraging build diversity. We should also not be too afraid of players finding a way to crack the game wide open with insane builds (just make sure they must work for it)!

Stylisation, JUICE and "feeling awesome" - All aspects of the game (Visuals, Sounds, UI, Effects and general Gameplay) should aim to make the player feel like a BADASS!! We should dedicate a lot of time to juice and impact to make the player really feel like they are getting stronger and cooler!

CHVMBER

Core Mechanic

An outline of the core mechanic to make the rest of the lingo make sense!

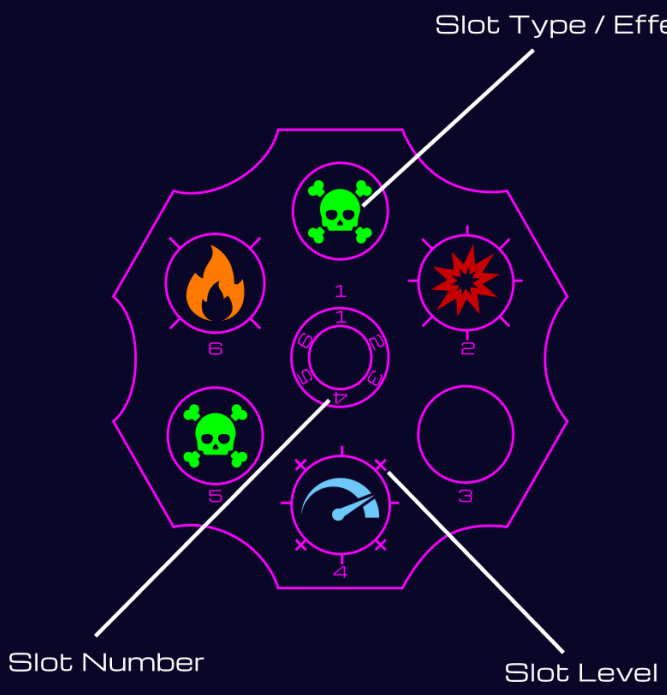
The Chamber



The player is equipped with a six-shooter revolver that has 6 bullets slots. These slots are the player's loadout. Throughout the run, they will be able to upgrade these bullet slots with different "perks" and effects, causing bullets fired out of the slot to behave differently.

For example, firing a bullet out of a "poison slot" will grant various poison effects.

Much like an actual gun chamber, firing a shot will cause it cycle to the next until it runs out. In which a slow reload will take place. After reloading, the bullets slots will remain in the same place.

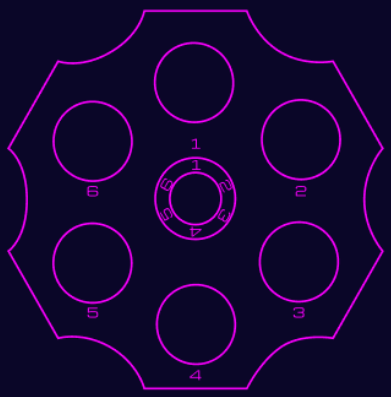


CHVMBER

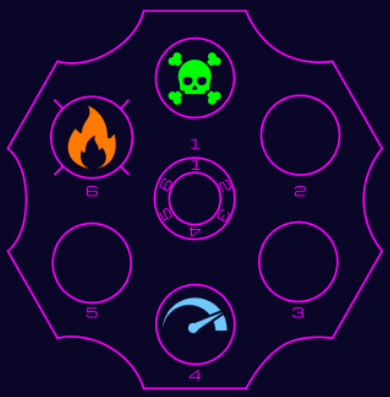
The chamber starts with 6 ‘blank slots’’, which are weak bullets with no upgrade trees. As they progress, they will be able to upgrade bullet slots to have special effects!

Bullet slots can be upgraded up to a certain number of levels, allowing for that constant sense of progression beyond simply getting 6 bullets.

Empty Chamber - Start of Game



Game Progresses



Game Progresses Further



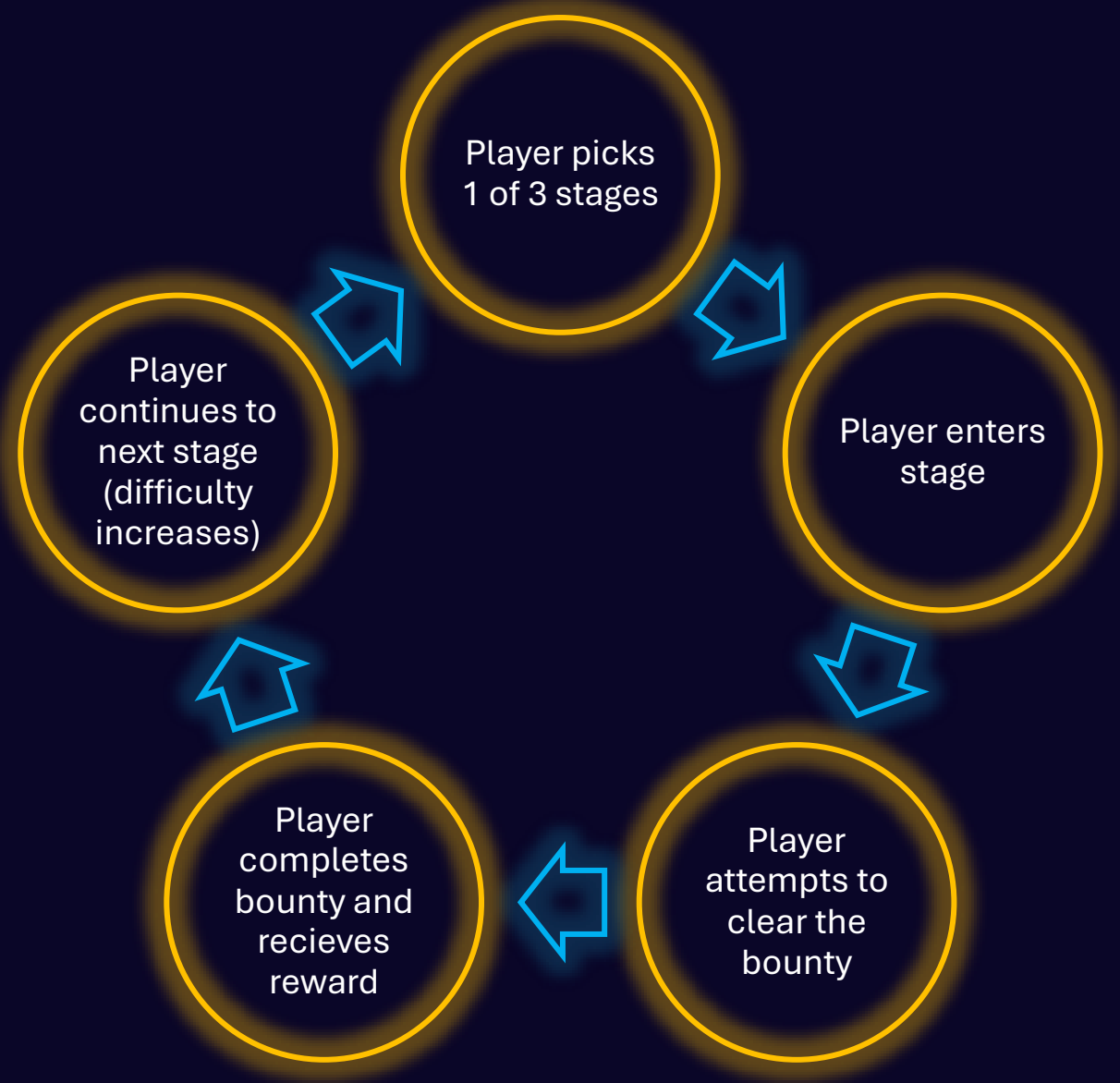
CHVMBER

Game Loop

An in-depth description of the Roguelike / Level progression system!

THIS WHOLE SECTION IS PURELY THEORETICAL SO FEEL FREE TO CHANGE!!

General Game Flow



Player Picks 1 of 3 Stages

Before entering the next stage, the player is given a choice of 3 stages to choose from. Here is an idea of one of the options seen below! This is NOT how it will look in the actual game! The level contains the following information:



- **Enemy Bounty and Icon –** Enemy gang Type of that stage
- **Difficulty / Modifiers –** Modifiers to the enemies to make them more difficult
- **Stage Location –** What pre-built level it will be / what environment it will be
- **Rewards –** The rewards for completing the level

Enemy Bounty

This is the current enemy type (‘gang’) the player will be facing for the stage. All enemies will be of said gang type. Different enemy types have different ways of acting so the player must adapt to the gang they are fighting. However, some bounties can be for multiple gangs at once.

Modifiers

Modifiers are unique events tied to the stage that make the encounter more unique and difficult for the player. These can be vastly different from each other.



Modifier Brainstorms

- **Strengthening enemies in unique ways –** More enemies / Improved stats / Unique abilities / Exploding on death

- **Debuffing the player in unique ways –** Reducing a stat / banning a specific chamber for the level / reloading slower / Hiding Chamber UI
- **Altering the stage and environment to be harder –** Foggy / Floor is lava / Asteroids falling / Lights Out
- **Other Unique alterations –** Gold is halved / Rewards are hidden

The amount/difficulty of the modifier will also affect the overall difficulty for the stage, and thus the number of rewards given to the player.

Stage Locations

Each location will be a small, almost "playground–like" stage, built in a modular way. The stages will all look very similar to reduce scope, with only slight changes via the colour palette or the occasional unique asset.

Gameplay-wise, the stages should be of a suitable size to allow the player some breathing room, but never fully safe. These areas should focus on testing the player in unique ways and encourage level-to-level adaptation (i.e. verticality, less cover, more cover, symmetry, asymmetry).

Rewards

This is what the player will get for clearing the stage bounty. The harder the bounty, the better the reward! Rewards can be any of the following:



Reward Brainstorms

- **Shops and Vendors –** Unique effects where the player will pay a cost to gain a more unique reward, allowing them more agency over their run.
- **Miscellaneous –** Other minor rewards that provide value to run in less direct ways. E.g. increasing a bullet's base stats

- **Bullet Reward** Here the player will receive a choice of 3 items.

  Each item can either be a new bullet slot (that can replace a ‘blank’ bullet) or an upgrade to a pre-existing bullet slot in their chamber.

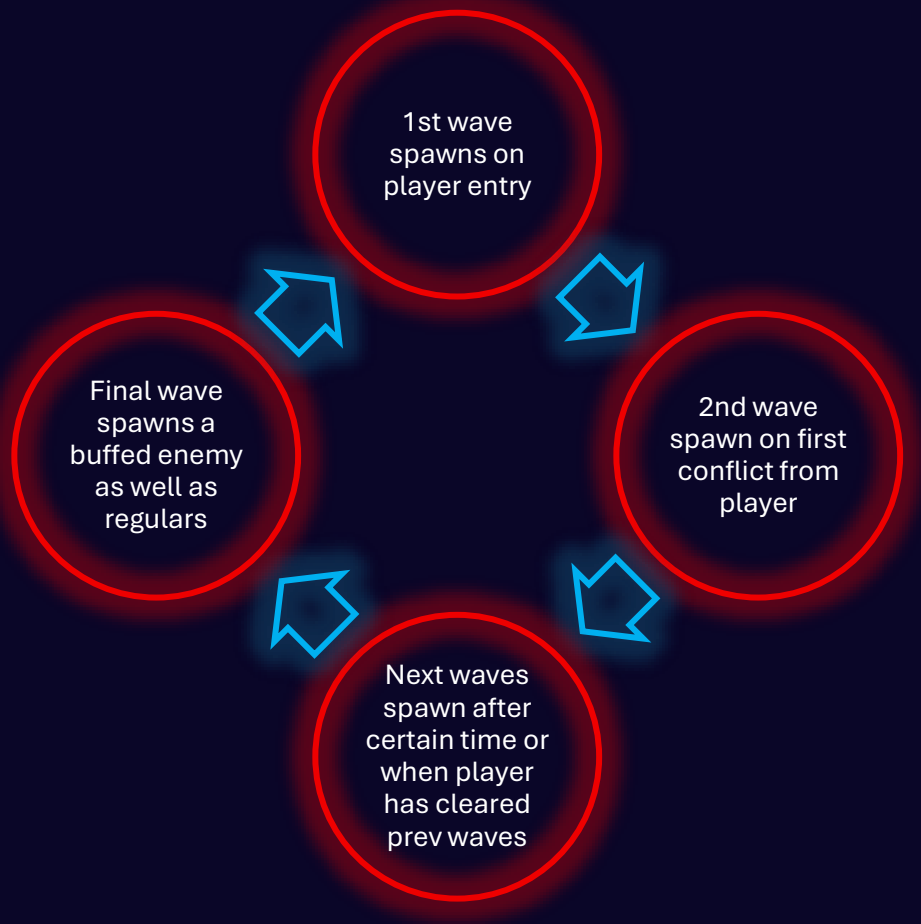
Player Enters Stage

To keep the feeling of progress and the atmosphere of “hunting bounties”. The transition segments will be the player travelling from one stage to the next, rather than the enemies coming to them. This makes them feel more badass as they aren’t “surviving”, they are hunting.

Player Attempts to Clear Bounty

Bounty System

Clearing a bounty always involves the same minor gameplay loop as shown below. The core gameplay involves a smaller form of a wave-based game that must all be completed to proceed. They must complete all waves to proceed.



1St Wave

The first wave consists of a minute number of enemies to give the player time to get their bearings in the level and position themselves correctly. This first wave is not that aggressive and sets up the scene.

2nd Wave

This wave begins after the player initiates combat by shooting an enemy. This immediately spawns a larger wave, which is of average difficulty. From here, a countdown until the next wave begins.

Subsequent Waves

Whenever either the countdown for the latest wave finishes or the player clears all previous waves, a new wave will spawn in and set the countdown (increasing in difficulty). This is repeated until the Final Wave.

Final Wave

The boss wave should be the hardest wave of the stage, as it contains a "boss" enemy, a rendition of the basic enemy that is larger / stronger, as well as the standard enemies. From here, enemies will only stop spawning when the boss is dead. Once all enemies are wiped out, the player will have cleared the stage!

Player Receives Reward

The player gains the rewards associated with the stage they chose. This comes in the form of a…

Player Continues to the Next Stage

After the player receives the reward for clearing the stage, they then proceed to the next stage, and the difficulty increases.

Short-term difficulty – Within a singular run

Much like most roguelikes, the player must try to keep pace with the difficulty so as not to fall behind and eventually game over. As the game is not planned to be infinite, the overall difficulty curve for each stage within will FEEL linear, leading up to the final stage. However, enemies will likely scale exponentially to match the player's power scaling and thus sell that linear feel.

Long-term Difficulty – Rogue-lite elements

To assist struggling players and to give run-to-run progression, rogue-lite elements could be added to allow the user to allow for the goal more reachable.

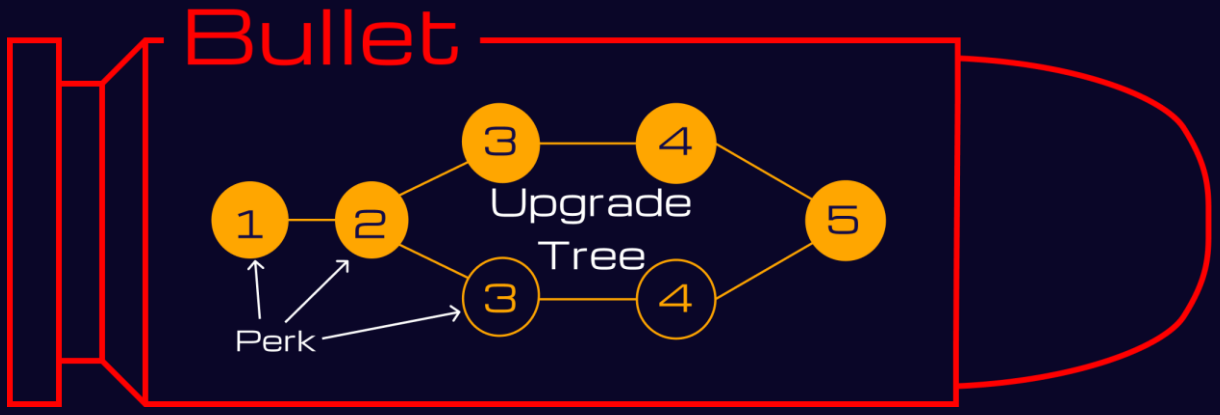
Although possible, the player should not be expected to beat the game in a single run. The game should become "easier" as the player's skill/knowledge develops or as the player accumulates more permanent upgrades.

Gameplay Mechanics

A description of the different mechanics and how they will affect the player's gameplay.

Bullets, Perks and Keywords

Throughout the run, the player can acquire new bullets slots to add to replace in their chamber (only 1 bullet per slot). Each bullet slot contains a miniature upgrade tree made of **Perks** (small effects that uniquely assist the player).



Each perk has an associated condition that is required for the effect to take place. These conditions are called **Keywords.**

All Keywords listed below:

On Shot – Applies effect immediately when the bullet is shot. The effect may last for a set time, or until the next bullet is shot.

On Hit – Applies effect when the bullet hits something, whether that is an enemy or a wall.

On Loaded – Applies effect only when this bullet is to be fired next (loaded in the barrel). As soon as the bullet is shot, the effect will stop.

In Chamber – Applies effects while the bullet is in the round. Once they have fired it, the effect stops and reactivates only when the gun is reloaded.

All Perks MUST have an associated Keyword applied. Here is a list below of some funky fresh perk examples:

Example Perks with their associated keywords:

On Shot – Launch all close enemies away from player

On Hit – Set all surrounding enemies on fire

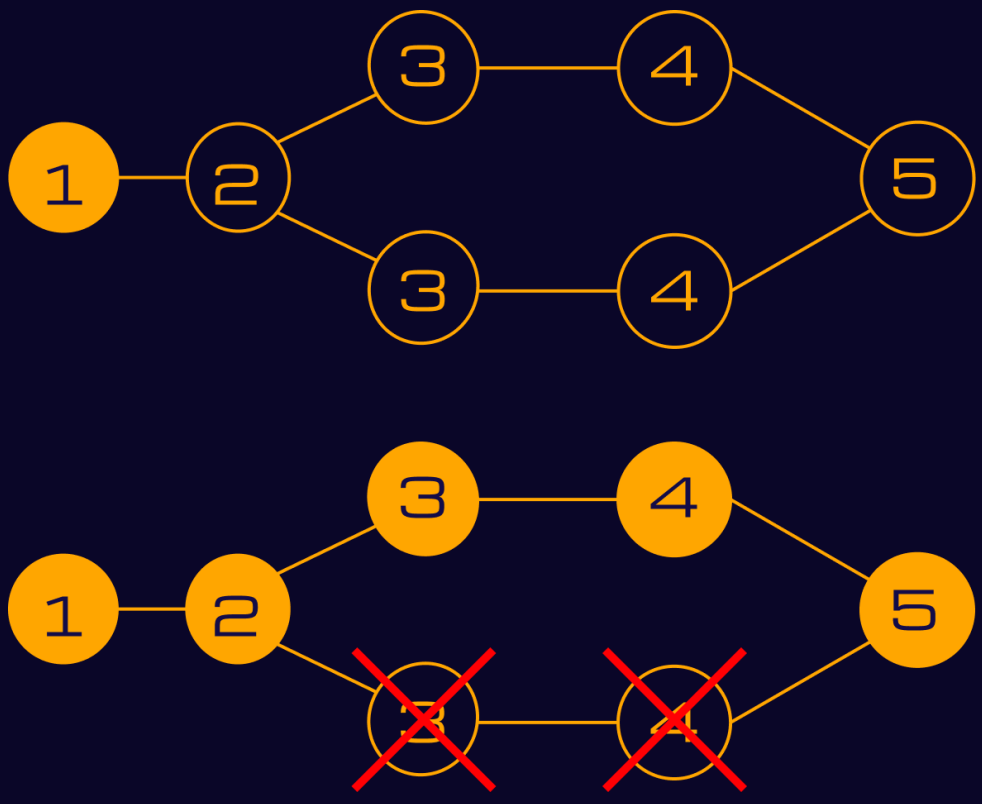
On Loaded – Slowly regen health

In Chamber – Increase damage of all critical hits by 10%

Bullet Slot Upgrade Tree

Bullets slots can be upgraded up to a maximum level of 5. Whenever a bullet is upgraded, it is advanced along the upgrade tree thus unlocking a new perk. Sometimes, the upgrade tree branches allowing the player to make a choice. Picking a path locks the other path out of the upgrade tree. The bullet maintains all previous perks as they upgrade causing it to be stronger with every upgrade.

Upgrade tree example:

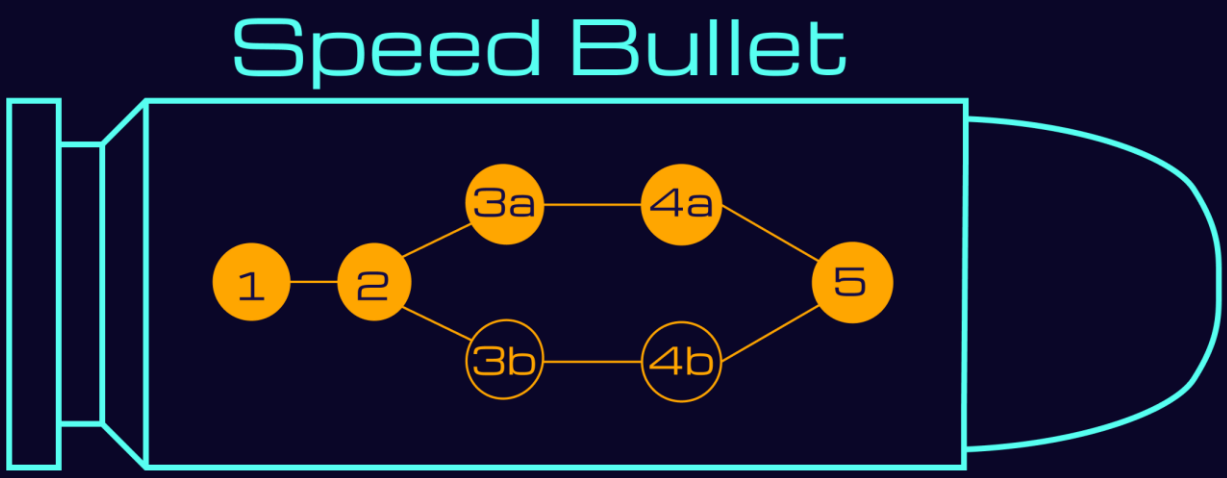


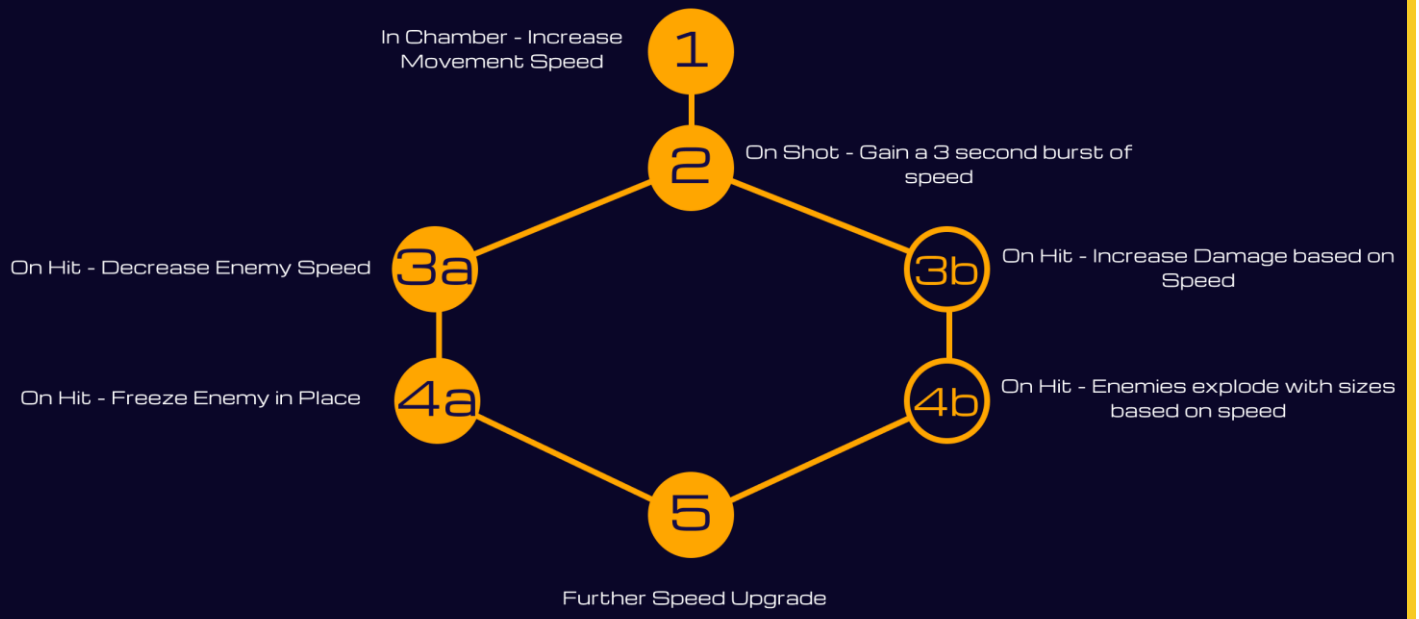
When creating paths, try and make that perks along said path lean into each other! I.e. if making a “lifesteal” path, make sure all perks lean into that to some degree.

Full Bullet Example:

Here is a fully upgraded version on the ‘Speed Bullet’ that went the path on freezing enemies.

Additional Perk Ideas can be found in this Document: CHVMBER - PERK LIST.docx





Vendors

THIS WHOLE SECTION IS PURELY THEORETICAL SO FEEL FREE TO CHANGE!!

The Vendors will be a somewhat rare, typically appearing only once or twice per run, where the player can use their chamber bullets as "currency".

- A shop where the player can buy a bullet, but at a cost of a certain number of bullets. Example: Buy a powerful legendary explosive bullet, which costs 2 of their current bullets and returns them to "default" bullets.
- A duplicator to duplicate one of your current bullets, replacing a different bullet in your chamber.
- A combiner, to combine 2 of the same bullets to make the product a stronger variant.

Enemies / Enemy Gangs

Enemies should be relatively manageable on their own however become more threatening as if they gain numbers over the player.

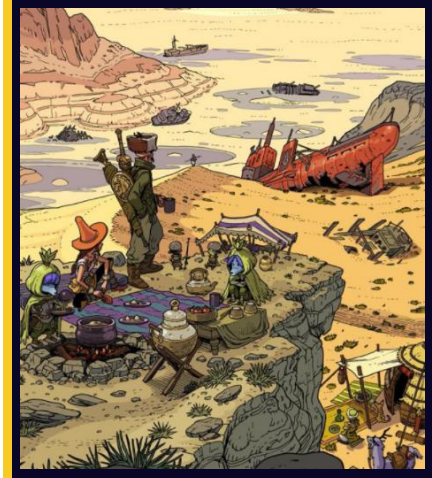
Enemy Gangs

When the player selects a stage, they will encounter a "Gang" based on the stage. These gangs consist of specific types of enemies that will spawn for that stage. Each gang has a theme however gangs can mix and match so that there is variability within each level.

Look and Feel

Visual Themes

The overall theme is **Space-Cowboy**, with a focus on merging Western and Sci-Fi to reach a more "future junkyard" style. Lots of cables and rustic metals sell the scruffiness of Western Cowboys within the refinements of space crafts.







Art-Style

The art style will have a more **Cartoonish** look to it, adopting a cel-shaded look to it that brings a more vibrant look to the game while still maintaining a bit of grit. A lot of the textures should have a been hand-drawn tinge to it and to play into this more.



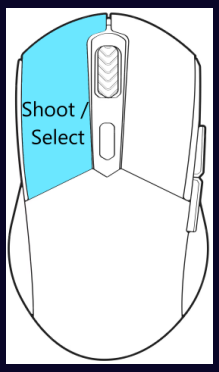
Assets can be simple and stylised and should lean into exaggeration of proportions.

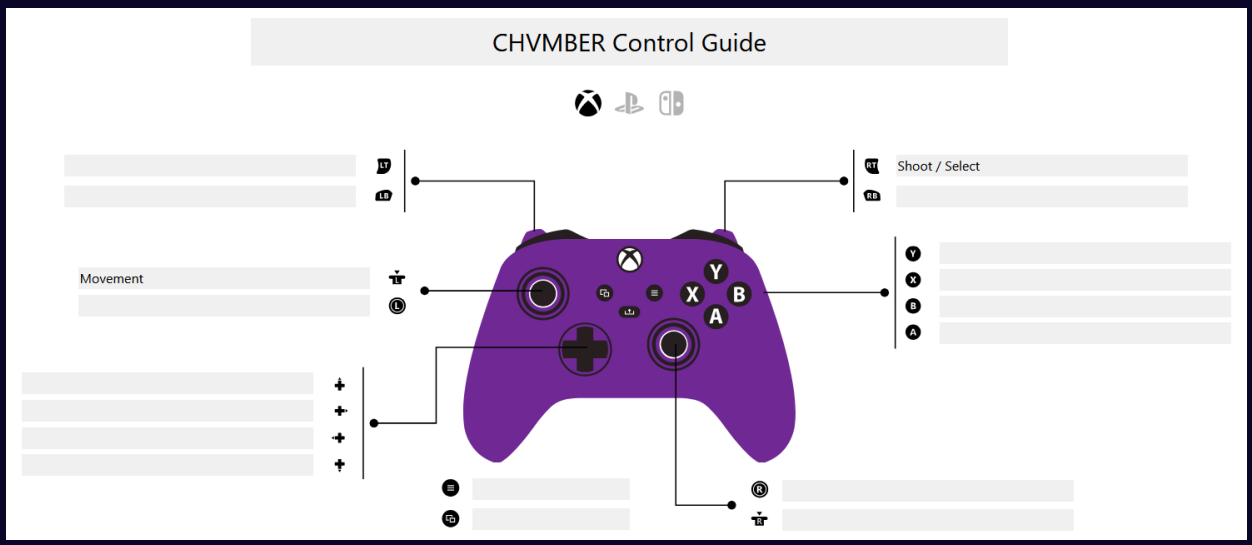
More details can be found here: Oatcake Interactive - Chamber Art Bible.pptx!

Controls

To maintain some pick-up-and-play elements, there should not be many controls. Right now, the player should only need the ability to move and shoot for the game. The buttons assigned to move and shoot are the common ones used in shooters. However, we can add concepts like jumping and reloading if the game doesn't feel complex enough!





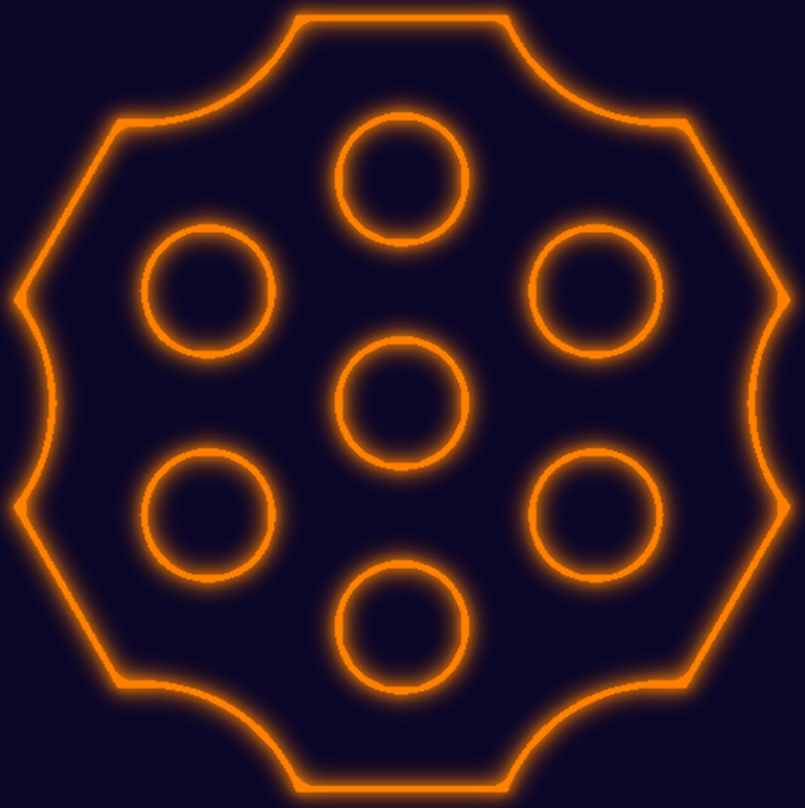


Story and Lore

The player is a bounty hunter trying going from gang to gang to collect enough money to… and that's all we got XD

Honestly we are open to anything as long as it is on theme and ties into the roguelike! Go wild!

CHVMBER



Design Document

Oatcake Interactive

Current GDD Status: Incomplete